



Richard's NFL Playoff Pool

LXI — Official Rulebook

2026 / 2027 NFL Playoffs

*Pool #1: Pick the Score (Visible) | Pool #2: Pick the Score (Blind) | Pool #3: Winner / ATS / O-U
Perfect Score Bonus | 25 Prizes | Entry Fee: \$25*

This rulebook covers all aspects of the pool. Season-specific dates, fees, and matchups are confirmed before each season opens.

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1. Pool Overview

Welcome to Richard's NFL Playoff Pool LXI! This is the 61st NFL PLAYOFF in second year for playoff pool. The pool covers all four rounds of the NFL playoffs — Wild Card, Divisional, Conference Championships, and the Super Bowl. Every paid player competes in all three pools simultaneously, and a Perfect Score Bonus gives every player an additional way to win money on every single game.

1.1 The Three Pools

Pool #1: Pick the Score (Visible) — Predict the exact final score of every game, both teams. Your picks are visible to all other players immediately after you submit them. Pool #1 also automatically populates your Pool #3 picks for WINNER, AGAINST THE SPREAD (ATS) and Over/Under or O/U.

Pool #2: Pick the Score (Blind) — You make the same score predictions as Pool #1 — both teams' scores for every game — but your picks are hidden from all other players until the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week. Pool #2 is completely independent from Pool #1 in terms of saves and timestamps.

Pool #3: Winner / ATS / O-U (Blind) — For each game you pick three things: the outright Winner, the Against the Spread (ATS) result, and whether the combined score goes Over or Under the betting line. Pool #3 picks are derived automatically from your Pool #1 score submissions and are hidden until the Friday deadline, but can be edited independently before the deadline.

Perfect Score Bonus — A separate bonus prize funded from entry fees. Any player who predicts the exact final score of any game in Pool #1 or Pool #2 earns a Perfect Score hit. Paid out at end of season.

1.2 Pool Structure

- Entry fee: \$25 — covers all 4 weeks and all 3 pools
- One entry fee per player — no separate entries per pool
- 25 total prizes: 10 Pool #1 prizes + 10 Pool #2 prizes + 5 Pool #3 prizes
- Perfect Score Bonus is a separate pot — see Section 10
- All prizes paid out after the season is fully complete
- Invitation only — access codes issued by Pool Manager only

Prize Summary

- Pool #1 Prizes: #1 through #10 — 2 per week for Weeks 1–3, 4 prizes in Week 4
- Pool #2 Prizes: #11 through #20 — mirrors Pool #1 prize structure exactly
- Pool #3 Prizes: #21 through #25 — 1 per week for all 4 weeks, plus 1 Grand Prize
- Perfect Score Bonus: Separate pot funded from 10% of total entry fees — see Section 10
- All prizes are equal shares of the main prize pool (90% of total fees ÷ 25 prizes)

1.3 The 2026/2027 Season Schedule

Playoff Schedule

- Wild Card Round: January 16–18, 2027 (6 games)
- Divisional Round: January 23–24, 2027 (4 games)
- Conference Championships: January 31, 2027 (2 games)
- Super Bowl LXI: February 14, 2027 (1 game)

Total: 13 games across 4 weeks

2. Entry Requirements & Payment

2.1 Entry Fee

The entry fee for the 2026/2027 season is \$25 per player. This fee covers all 4 weeks of the playoffs and all 3 pools.

Payment Details:

- E-transfer to: gammoneer2b@gmail.com
- E-transfer password: nflpool
- Include your full name in the payment message
- Payment must be confirmed by the Pool Manager before your access code is activated

2.2 Access Codes

Each player receives a unique 6-character alphanumeric access code upon payment confirmation.

- One code per player — valid for all 4 weeks of the season and all 3 pools
- Your name is pre-loaded by the Pool Manager — enter your code in the app to access your picks
- Pool Manager requires your first and last name, email address and mobile # for texts,
- DO NOT share your access code — you are responsible for all picks submitted under your code
- Lost codes: contact the Pool Manager to have your code re-sent

2.3 Late Entry

Late entries may be accepted at the Pool Manager's discretion, subject to all of the following:

- The pool has not reached maximum capacity
- Payment is received and confirmed at least 1 hour before the Week 1 deadline
- The player enters picks immediately after payment confirmation

Late entries who fail to submit picks before the deadline will have RNG picks applied automatically — see Section 11.

3. Pick Submission Schedule & Deadlines

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS ALL DEADLINES

All picks for each week lock at Friday 11:59 PM PST before that playoff weekend's games.

This applies to Pool #1, Pool #2, and Pool #3. No exceptions.

3.1 Weekly Pick Windows

- Week 1 (Wild Card Round): Pool opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — approximately 5 days (Monday through Friday). Deadline: Friday 11:59 PM PST before Wild Card games begin Saturday January 16, 2027.
- Week 2 (Divisional Round): Opens Tuesday 12:01 AM PST — Wild Card weekend includes a Monday night game so Week 2 cannot open until Tuesday. Approximately 4 days (Tuesday through Friday). Deadline: Friday 11:59 PM PST.
- Week 3 (Conference Championships): Opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — Divisional games finish Sunday night. Approximately 5 days (Monday through Friday). Deadline: Friday 11:59 PM PST.
- Week 4 (Super Bowl): Opens Monday 12:01 AM PST — Conference games finish Sunday night. Approximately 11 days (Monday through Friday February 13, 2027). Deadline: Friday 11:59 PM PST before Super Bowl weekend.

WILD CARD	Saturday, January 16, 2027	2:30:00 PM
WILD CARD	Saturday, January 16, 2027	6:00:00 PM
WILD CARD	Sunday, January 17, 2027	11:00:00 AM
WILD CARD	Sunday, January 17, 2027	2:30:00 PM
WILD CARD	Sunday, January 17, 2027	6:15:00 PM
WILD CARD	Monday, January 18, 2027	6:15:00 PM
DIVISIONAL	Saturday, January 23, 2027	2:30:00 PM
DIVISIONAL	Saturday, January 23, 2027	6:15:00 PM
DIVISIONAL	Sunday, January 24, 2027	1:00:00 PM
DIVISIONAL	Sunday, January 24, 2027	4:30:00 PM
CONFERENCE	Sunday, January 31, 2027	1:00:00 PM
CONFERENCE	Sunday, January 31, 2027	4:30:00 PM
SUPERBOWL	Sunday, February 14, 2027	4:30:00 PM

3.2 Editing Picks

- Picks can be edited unlimited times from when they are first entered until Friday 11:59 PM PST
- After the Friday deadline, picks are permanently locked automatically by the app
- If a player has no picks saved at all when the deadline passes, the app automatically generates RNG picks — see Section 11
- No changes are possible once locked — picks stand exactly as entered

Best Practice

Enter your picks as early as possible in each week's pick window and refine them as needed before the Friday deadline.

Every week has a defined window — use it.

Important: Every time you save picks, your timestamp for that pool updates to that moment.

The timestamp is the final tiebreaker — submitting early and editing less often gives you a tiebreaker advantage.

3.3 The 24-Hour Support Rule

The Pool Manager cannot guarantee monitoring or support in the final 24 hours before any deadline.

- Report technical issues MORE than 24 hours before the deadline — Pool Manager may be able to assist
- Report issues LESS than 24 hours before the deadline — you are on your own

The responsibility to enter picks on time rests entirely with each player.

4. Pool #1: Pick the Score — How to Play

4.1 What You Are Predicting

For every game in the current week, you predict the final score of both teams in Pool #1. The team you give the higher score is your predicted winner.

Example

You enter: KC 28 — LV 17

You are predicting KC wins 28–17.

KC is your predicted winner.

4.2 All-or-Nothing Submission

Every score field for every game in that week must be filled in before your picks can be submitted. You cannot submit partial picks.

- Enter a number in every field — even rough estimates count as valid picks
- If any field is empty the submission is rejected — fill in all fields first
- Once submitted, picks stand as entered — unusual or extreme numbers are valid

4.3 Visibility

Pool #1 picks are visible to all players immediately after you submit them. There is no blind period for Pool #1.

4.4 How Pool #3 Picks Are Auto-Populated From Pool #1

When you save your Pool #1 score picks, the app automatically calculates your Pool #3 picks (Winner, ATS, and O/U) from your Pool #1 scores using the current betting lines, and saves them to Pool #3 at the same time with the same timestamp.

If the Pool Manager has not yet entered the betting lines when you submit your Pool #1 picks, your Pool #3 picks will remain empty temporarily. As soon as the Pool Manager enters the lines, the app will automatically calculate and save Pool #3 picks for all players who have Pool #1 picks but no Pool #3 picks yet. You do not need to do anything — your Pool #3 will be filled in automatically but you can edit Pool #3 if you like.

Pool #3 Timestamp Rule

Your Pool #3 submission timestamp is set to match your Pool #1 submission timestamp — not the time the lines were entered by the Pool Manager.

This means submitting your Pool #1 picks early automatically gives you an early Pool #3 timestamp as well.

If you manually edit any of your Pool #3 picks afterward and save, your Pool #3 timestamp updates to the time of that manual save.

Tiebreaker tip: Submit your Pool #1 picks early. This locks in an early timestamp for Pool #3 automatically — even if you never manually edit your Pool #3 picks.

4.5 Scoring in Pool #1

Pool #1 does not award points per game — it determines prize winners based on two criteria:

- Most Correct Winners — how many game winners you predicted correctly across all games in that week
- Closest Total Points — how close your predicted total (sum of all game total score predictions in the week) is to the actual combined total for that week

These two criteria each award prizes each week. See Section 7 for full prize details.

5. Pool #2: Pick the Score (Blind) — How to Play

5.1 What You Are Predicting

Pool #2 is identical to Pool #1 in terms of what you enter — you predict the final score of both teams for every game in the week. The only difference is that your picks are hidden from all other players until the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes.

5.2 The Blind Period

Pool #2 picks are hidden from all other players until the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week. After the deadline, all Pool #2 picks become visible to everyone.

This blind period is designed to prevent players from copying each other's score predictions. Your Pool #1 picks are always visible immediately after submission — Pool #2 gives you a separate, independent blind entry.

5.3 Pool #2 Is Independent from Pool #1

Pool #2 picks are completely separate from your Pool #1 picks and have their own independent timestamp.

- You can enter different scores in Pool #2 than in Pool #1
- Saving Pool #1 does NOT affect your Pool #2 picks or timestamp
- Saving Pool #2 does NOT affect your Pool #1 picks or timestamp
- You must save Pool #2 separately — it is not automatically populated from Pool #1

Pool #2 Timestamp Rule

Your Pool #2 timestamp is set to the moment you save your Pool #2 picks.

If you edit and save Pool #2 again, your Pool #2 timestamp updates to that newer save time.

Tiebreaker tip: Submit your Pool #2 picks early in the week. Every save updates your timestamp to a later time — edit only when you genuinely want to change your picks.

5.4 Scoring in Pool #2

Pool #2 uses the same scoring criteria as Pool #1:

- Most Correct Winners — how many game winners you predicted correctly in Pool #2 for that week
- Closest Total Points — how close your Pool #2 predicted total is to the actual combined total for that week

See Section 8 for full Pool #2 prize details. Prizes #11–#20 mirror the Pool #1 prize structure exactly.

6. Pool #3: Winner / ATS / O-U — How to Play

6.1 Overview

Pool #3 is a separate pool based on betting lines — the same type of lines used by professional sportsbooks. For each game you make three picks: the outright Winner, the Against the Spread (ATS) result, and the Over/Under (O/U). Each pick is scored independently.

Pool #3 picks are automatically derived from your Pool #1 score submissions but can be edited independently before the Friday deadline. Picks are hidden from all other players until the deadline passes.

6.2 The Three Picks Per Game

Pick 1: Winner (2 points)

Pick which team wins the game outright. When you submit your Pool #1 score predictions, the app automatically sets your Pool #3 Winner pick to whichever team you predicted to score more points in Pool #1. You can change this independently in Pool #3 if you wish.

Pick 2: Against the Spread — ATS (3 points)

The spread is a points handicap assigned to the favourite team by the betting line. It levels the playing field by requiring the favourite to win by more than a set margin for the pick to be correct.

How to read the spread:

- A team listed as the FAVOURITE has a MINUS (–) number — for example –10. They must win by MORE than 10 points for a pick on them to be correct.
- A team listed as the UNDERDOG has a PLUS (+) number — for example +10. They cover the spread if they win outright OR if they lose by fewer than 10 points.
- The spread almost always ends in .5 — for example –7.5 or +4.5. This ensures the margin can never land exactly on the spread number, so there is never a push or tie on the ATS pick. You are always either right or wrong.

ATS Example: LAC –7.5 at HOU +7.5

LAC is the favourite. They must win by 8 or more points for a LAC ATS pick to be correct.

HOU is the underdog. They cover if they win outright OR if they lose by 7 points or fewer.

Your Pool #1 prediction: LAC 45 — HOU 33. App auto-sets your ATS pick to LAC –7.5 since you predicted LAC to win by 12.

Actual result: LAC 34 — HOU 31. LAC won by only 3 points — less than 7.5.

LAC did NOT cover the spread.

- If your ATS pick was LAC –7.5 → ❌ Wrong (0 points)

- If your ATS pick was HOU +7.5 →  Correct (3 points) — HOU only lost by 3, within their +7.5 cushion

Simple rule: The minus team must win big. The plus team just needs to stay close or win outright.

Pick 3: Over / Under — O/U (3 points)

The Over/Under line is a number representing the expected combined total points scored by both teams. You pick whether the actual combined total will be Over or Under that number.

Like the spread, the O/U line will always end in .5. This ensures the combined score can never land exactly on the line — you are always either Over or Under, never exactly on the number.

O/U Example: Line is 42.5

Actual result: LAC 34 + HOU 31 = 65 combined points.
65 is greater than 42.5 → the result is OVER.

- If your pick was Over →  Correct (3 points)
- If your pick was Under →  Wrong (0 points)

Simple rule: Add both teams' final scores together. Is the total bigger or smaller than the O/U line?

6.3 Points Per Game in Pool #3

For each game in Pool #3 you can earn a maximum of 8 points:

- Winner correct: 2 points
- ATS correct: 3 points
- O/U correct: 3 points
- Maximum per game: 8 points

Weekly maximum points:

- Wild Card (6 games): maximum 48 points
- Divisional (4 games): maximum 32 points
- Conference (2 games): maximum 16 points
- Super Bowl (1 game): maximum 8 points

6.4 Betting Lines — Where They Come From

The Pool Manager enters the favourite, spread, and O/U for each game as early as possible at the start of each week. Once entered, lines are locked for the entire week and do not change.

- Week 1 (Wild Card): Lines entered Monday as early as possible

- Week 2 (Divisional): Lines entered Tuesday as early as possible
- Week 3 (Conference): Lines entered Monday as early as possible
- Week 4 (Super Bowl): Lines entered Monday as early as possible

Players do not need to monitor the lines for any shifting — what is set at the start of the week counts through to the Friday deadline.

7. Pool #1 Prize Structure & Tiebreaker Rules (Prizes #1–#10)

7.1 Prize Distribution

- Prize #1 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #2 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Closest Total Points
- Prize #3 — Week 2 (Divisional): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #4 — Week 2 (Divisional): Closest Total Points
- Prize #5 — Week 3 (Conference): Most Correct Winners
- Prize #6 — Week 3 (Conference): Closest Total Points
- Prize #7 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Correct Super Bowl Winner
- Prize #8 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Closest Super Bowl Total Points
- Prize #9 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (all 4 weeks, all 13 games)
- Prize #10 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (all 4 weeks combined)

Critical Tiebreaker Philosophy

The goal of the tiebreaker system is to find one winner per prize.

The tiebreaker chain is designed so that a true unresolvable tie is extremely rare. Each step eliminates players until one remains. Only if every single tiebreaker step is fully exhausted and players remain exactly tied do they share the prize equally.

"Closest" always means absolute difference — being 5 points over or 5 points under the actual total points is the same result (5 points away). Direction does not matter, only distance.

The timestamp is the ultimate final tiebreaker. If all other steps are exhausted, the player who submitted their picks earliest wins. The time-stamp is to the nearest split seconds. Submitting early gives you a tiebreaker advantage.

7.2 How Tiebreakers Work — The Elimination Process

Every tiebreaker follows this elimination process:

1. Apply the next tiebreaker step to all remaining tied players
2. Find which player(s) have the best result at that step
3. Keep ONLY those players with the best result — drop everyone else
4. If only one player remains → that player wins
5. If multiple players remain → move to the next step and repeat
6. If all levels exhausted and still ties then use earliest time-stamp wins.
7. If all steps exhausted and all time-stamps checked for earliest time but still tied → share prize equally

7.3 Prize #1 — Week 1: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 1.

Tiebreaker chain:

8. Compare tied players' Week 1 total points (closest to actual wins, others eliminated)
9. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
10. If still tied → share prize

7.4 Prize #2 — Week 1: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted total points for Week 1 is closest to the actual combined total.

Tiebreaker chain:

11. Earliest submission timestamp wins
12. If still tied → share prize

7.5 Prize #3 — Week 2: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 2.

Tiebreaker chain:

13. Compare tied players' Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
14. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
15. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
16. If still tied → share prize

7.6 Prize #4 — Week 2: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted Week 2 total is closest to actual.

Tiebreaker chain:

17. Look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
18. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
19. If still tied → share prize

7.7 Prize #5 — Week 3: Most Correct Winners

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted winning NFL teams in Week 3.

Tiebreaker chain:

20. Compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
21. If still tied → look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
22. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
23. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
24. If still tied → share prize

7.8 Prize #6 — Week 3: Closest Total Points

Winner: Player whose predicted Week 3 total is closest to actual.

Tiebreaker chain:

- 25. Look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 26. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 27. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
- 28. If still tied → share prize

7.9 Prize #7 — Super Bowl: Correct Winner Pick

Winner: Player(s) who correctly predicted the Super Bowl winning team. If nobody picked correctly, all players are treated as tied and the full tiebreaker chain applies to everyone.

Tiebreaker chain (oldest to newest week — intentionally opposite to Prize #8 to reduce same player winning both):

- 29. Compare Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 30. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 31. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 32. If still tied → compare Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 33. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
- 34. If still tied → share prize

7.10 Prize #8 — Super Bowl: Closest Total Points (Super Bowl game only)

Winner: Player whose predicted Super Bowl total is closest to the actual Super Bowl combined score.

Note: Week 4 is skipped as a tiebreaker because Week 4 IS the Super Bowl — using it would be redundant. The chain goes straight to Week 3 and works backward.

Tiebreaker chain (newest to oldest week — intentionally opposite to Prize #7):

- 35. Look back to Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 36. If still tied → look back to Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 37. If still tied → look back to Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 38. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
- 39. If still tied → share prize

7.11 Prize #9 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player with the most correctly predicted game winners across all 13 games of the entire playoffs.

Tiebreaker chain:

- 40. Compare Grand Total points difference (combined 4-week predicted total vs actual — closest wins)
- 41. If still tied → compare Week 4 total points (closest wins)
- 42. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins)
- 43. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins)
- 44. If still tied → compare Week 1 total points (closest wins)
- 45. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
- 46. If still tied → share prize

7.12 Prize #10 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player whose combined 4-week predicted total is closest to the actual combined 4-week total.

Tiebreaker chain (work backward from most recent week):

- 47. Compare Week 4 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 48. If still tied → compare Week 3 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 49. If still tied → compare Week 2 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 50. If still tied → compare Week 1 total points (closest wins, others eliminated)
- 51. If still tied → earliest submission timestamp wins
- 52. If still tied → share prize

8. Pool #2 Prize Structure & Tiebreaker Rules (Prizes #11–#20)

8.1 Prize Distribution

Pool #2 prizes mirror Pool #1 exactly — same structure, same tiebreaker logic, applied to Pool #2 score picks and Pool #2 total points.

- Prize #11 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Most Correct Winners (Pool #2)
- Prize #12 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Closest Total Points (Pool #2)
- Prize #13 — Week 2 (Divisional): Most Correct Winners (Pool #2)
- Prize #14 — Week 2 (Divisional): Closest Total Points (Pool #2)
- Prize #15 — Week 3 (Conference): Most Correct Winners (Pool #2)
- Prize #16 — Week 3 (Conference): Closest Total Points (Pool #2)
- Prize #17 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Correct Super Bowl Winner (Pool #2)
- Prize #18 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Closest Super Bowl Total Points (Pool #2)
- Prize #19 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (all 4 weeks, Pool #2)
- Prize #20 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (all 4 weeks, Pool #2)

8.2 Tiebreaker Philosophy for Pool #2

Pool #2 Tiebreaker Note

All Pool #2 prizes use Pool #2 total points for tiebreakers, not Pool #1 total points.

The tiebreaker chain structure is identical to Pool #1 (Prizes #1–#10) but applied to Pool #2 data.

The timestamp used is the Pool #2 submission timestamp — independent from Pool #1.

The player who submitted their Pool #2 picks earliest wins if everything else is tied.

8.3 Prizes #11–#16 Tiebreaker Chains

Prizes #11–#16 use the same tiebreaker chains as Prizes #1–#6 respectively, with all references to "Pool #1 total points" replaced by "Pool #2 total points" and the Pool #2 submission timestamp used as final tiebreaker.

8.4 Prize #17 — Super Bowl: Correct Winner (Pool #2)

Same structure as Prize #7. Tiebreaker goes oldest to newest (Week 1→2→3→4) to reduce same player winning both Prize #17 and Prize #18.

Tiebreaker chain:

53. Compare Week 1 Pool #2 total points (closest wins)
54. If still tied → compare Week 2 Pool #2 total points
55. If still tied → compare Week 3 Pool #2 total points
56. If still tied → compare Week 4 Pool #2 total points

- 57.If still tied → earliest Pool #2 submission timestamp wins
- 58.If still tied → share prize

8.5 Prize #18 — Super Bowl: Closest Total Points (Pool #2)

Same structure as Prize #8. Tiebreaker goes newest to oldest (Week 3→2→1, skipping Week 4 since that IS the Super Bowl).

Tiebreaker chain:

- 59.Look back to Week 3 Pool #2 total points (closest wins)
- 60.If still tied → look back to Week 2 Pool #2 total points
- 61.If still tied → look back to Week 1 Pool #2 total points
- 62.If still tied → earliest Pool #2 submission timestamp wins
- 63.If still tied → share prize

8.6 Prize #19 — Grand Prize: Most Correct Winners (All 4 Weeks, Pool #2)

Tiebreaker chain:

- 64.Compare Pool #2 Grand Total points difference (4-week combined — closest wins)
- 65.If still tied → compare Week 4 Pool #2 total points
- 66.If still tied → compare Week 3 Pool #2 total points
- 67.If still tied → compare Week 2 Pool #2 total points
- 68.If still tied → compare Week 1 Pool #2 total points
- 69.If still tied → earliest Pool #2 submission timestamp wins
- 70.If still tied → share prize

8.7 Prize #20 — Grand Prize: Closest Total Points (All 4 Weeks, Pool #2)

Tiebreaker chain (work backward from most recent week):

- 71.Compare Week 4 Pool #2 total points (closest wins)
- 72.If still tied → compare Week 3 Pool #2 total points
- 73.If still tied → compare Week 2 Pool #2 total points
- 74.If still tied → compare Week 1 Pool #2 total points
- 75.If still tied → earliest Pool #2 submission timestamp wins
- 76.If still tied → share prize

9. Pool #3 Prize Structure & Tiebreaker Rules (Prizes #21–#25)

9.1 Prize Distribution

- Prize #21 — Week 1 (Wild Card): Most Pool #3 Points
- Prize #22 — Week 2 (Divisional): Most Pool #3 Points
- Prize #23 — Week 3 (Conference): Most Pool #3 Points
- Prize #24 — Week 4 (Super Bowl): Most Pool #3 Points
- Prize #25 — Grand Prize: Most Pool #3 Points (all 4 weeks combined)

9.2 Tiebreaker Philosophy for Pool #3

Pool #3 Tiebreaker Note

Weekly prizes (#21–#24): Most points that week wins. Tiebreaker = earliest Pool #3 submission timestamp.

Grand Prize (#25): Most total Pool #3 points across all 4 weeks wins.

If still tied after total points are compared → players share the prize equally.

There is no timestamp tiebreaker for the Pool #3 Grand Prize.

9.3 Prizes #21–#24 — Weekly Pool #3 Prizes

Winner each week: Player with the most Pool #3 points in that week.

Tiebreaker chain (same for all 4 weekly Pool #3 prizes):

77. Earliest Pool #3 submission timestamp wins
78. If still tied → share prize

9.4 Prize #25 — Grand Prize: Most Pool #3 Points (All 4 Weeks)

Winner: Player with the most combined Pool #3 points across all 4 weeks of the playoffs.

Tiebreaker chain:

79. If total points are tied → share prize equally

Note: There is no timestamp tiebreaker for the Pool #3 Grand Prize. A tied grand total means players share the prize.

10. Perfect Score Bonus

10.1 What Is the Perfect Score Bonus?

The Perfect Score Bonus rewards any player who predicts the exact final score of any game in Pool #1 or Pool #2 — meaning both teams' scores are correct to the exact point. The visiting team score AND the home team score must both be exactly right.

Perfect Score Example

Game: Visiting Team B at Home Team A

Actual final score: Visiting Team B 34 — Home Team A 43

A Perfect Score hit requires predicting EXACTLY: Visitor 34 and Home 43.

Getting one number right but not the other does NOT count.

Getting the winner right but wrong scores does NOT count.

A player can earn a PS hit from Pool #1 AND a separate PS hit from Pool #2 for the same game, counting as 2 hits total — since Pool #1 and Pool #2 are independent submissions.

10.2 How the Bonus Pot Is Funded

10% of the total entry fees collected from all players is set aside as the Perfect Score Bonus pot at the start of the season. The remaining 90% is divided equally among the 25 main prizes.

Funding Example: 20 players × \$25 entry fee = \$500 total entry fees

- Perfect Score Bonus pot: $\$500 \times 10\% = \50
- Main prize pool: $\$500 \times 90\% = \450
- Each of the 25 prizes: $\$450 \div 25 = \18 per prize

The exact prize amounts for the current season are displayed in the app under Prizes, Standings & Results.

10.3 How to Win the Perfect Score Bonus

A Perfect Score hit is recorded any time a player's Pool #1 or Pool #2 score prediction matches the actual final score exactly — both the away team score AND the home team score must be correct.

- A player can earn PS hits from Pool #1, Pool #2, or both for the same game (counts as 2 hits)
- A player can earn multiple Perfect Score hits in a single week — one per game per pool
- A player can earn Perfect Score hits across multiple weeks throughout the season
- There is no limit to how many PS hits a single player can earn
- Each PS hit counts equally regardless of which week, which game, or which pool it occurred in
- Games are numbered sequentially: Wild Card = Games 1–6, Divisional = Games 7–10, Conference = Games 11–12, Super Bowl = Game 13

10.4 How the Bonus Pot Is Paid Out

After the season is fully complete and all 13 games are final, the total number of Perfect Score hits across all players, all games, and both pools (Pool #1 and Pool #2) is counted. The pot is then divided equally by the total number of hits.

Payout Example

Perfect Score pot = \$50

Hits across all players all season:

- Richard — 2 PS hits (Pool #1 Wild Card Game 3, Pool #2 Divisional Game 8)
- Dave — 1 PS hit (Pool #1 Conference Game 11)
- Total hits = 3

Payout per hit = $\$50 \div 3 = \16.67 per hit

- Richard receives \$33.34 (2 hits $\times$ \$16.67)
- Dave receives \$16.67 (1 hit $\times$ \$16.67)

Both players also remain fully eligible for all 25 main prizes — Perfect Score winnings are in addition to prize winnings, never instead of.

10.5 If Nobody Scores a Perfect Score All Season

If no player hits a perfect score across any game in any week during the entire season across Pool #1 and Pool #2, the Perfect Score pot does not go to waste.

Rollback Rule

The entire pot rolls back into the main prize pool and is divided equally among all 25 prizes.

Example: Perfect Score pot = \$50, zero hits all season

$\$50 \div 25 \text{ prizes} = \$2 \text{ extra per prize}$

If each prize was \$18, it becomes \$20 for the season.

10.6 Perfect Score Visibility

All Perfect Score hits are visible to all players at all times in the Prizes, Standings & Results section of the app. Individual hits are recorded and displayed as games are finalized throughout the season.

The final Perfect Score bonus payout calculation and dollar amounts per hit are not calculated until after the entire season is fully completed and all 13 games are final.

The Pool Manager has the ability to correct any hit that was recorded incorrectly due to a data error.

11. Random Number Generator (RNG) Rule

11.1 Purpose

Every paid player must have picks entered for every week of the playoffs. No paid player can skip a week. The RNG rule ensures this automatically.

11.2 When RNG Is Applied

After the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline, the app automatically generates RNG picks for any paid player who has zero picks saved for that week. This happens before the first game of that weekend kicks off.

- Applied only to players with no picks at all for that week — all fields completely empty
- Applied to Pool #1, Pool #2, and Pool #3 if any are empty
- Generated scores range from 10 to 45 per team
- Pool #3 RNG picks are derived from the RNG Pool #1 scores using the betting lines
- RNG picks count as the player's official entry for that week
- The Pool Manager verifies the app has applied RNG correctly after the deadline

11.3 When RNG Is NOT Applied

- Player entered any numbers at all — even rough estimates, even extreme numbers
- Player entered numbers but made a mistake — picks stand as entered
- Player wants to change picks after the deadline — too late
- Pool Manager thinks a player "meant something else" — no guessing, no substitutions

If you entered something — anything — it stands. RNG only applies when the submission is completely empty.

11.4 RNG Indicator

Players who received RNG picks will have a 🎲 (dice) indicator next to their name in the all-players picks table, the standings, and the prize breakdowns. This indicator is visible to all players so everyone can see which entries were system-generated.

Pick windows by week

- Week 1 (Wild Card): 5 days — Monday through Friday
- Week 2 (Divisional): 4 days — Tuesday through Friday
- Week 3 (Conference): 5 days — Monday through Friday
- Week 4 (Super Bowl): 11 days — Monday through the Friday before Super Bowl weekend

Every week has a defined pick window. Enter your picks early in each window and the 🎲 indicator will never apply to you.

12. Pool Manager Authority & Responsibilities

12.1 Pool Manager Role

The Pool Manager administers this pool as a service to the community — done for fun and community, not for compensation. The Pool Manager operates with complete integrity and fairness at all times.

This pool has been built over 1000+ hours of development and is backed by 25+ years of running regular season pools and 45+ years of pool participation experience.

12.2 What the Pool Manager Will Do

- Enter betting lines (favourite, spread, and O/U) for Pool #3 as early as possible at the start of each week
- Verify that the app has automatically applied RNG picks to any paid player with zero picks after the Friday deadline
- Verify prize winners calculated by the app after each playoff weekend and confirm they are correct
- Review all pick tables, actual scores, and prize calculations displayed in the app for accuracy
- Correct any data errors (scores, Perfect Score hits, etc.) using the Pool Manager Override tools in the app
- Investigate and resolve technical issues reported more than 24 hours before a deadline
- Review access code issues and re-send lost codes
- Consider late entries at discretion (see Section 2.3)
- Send a post-weekend email confirming prize winners and Perfect Score hits after each playoff weekend
- Make final decisions on any disputes — fairly and transparently

Note: The 🎲 dice indicator next to a player's name in the app is the notification that RNG was applied to that player — it is visible to all players including the affected player. The Pool Manager does not send individual notifications.

12.3 What the Pool Manager Will NOT Do

- Unlock or extend a deadline — this is extremely unlikely to ever happen and players should treat it as never going to occur. Plan accordingly.
- Edit or change a player's valid picks for any reason — picks stand as entered
- Change picks because a player "made a mistake" — if you submitted it, it counts
- Contact players to ask "did you mean this?" — no intent-guessing ever
- Apply RNG before the deadline — picks must be genuinely missing, not just late
- Give special treatment to any player based on friendship or circumstance

Why such firm rules?

Flexibility causes problems. One extension leads to requests for more. One exception becomes "why not me?"

These rules have worked smoothly for 25+ years. Everyone enters early, edits freely, and enjoys the pool with zero stress.

12.4 Dispute Resolution

The Pool Manager has final authority on all disputes. Decisions are based on:

- App timestamps — the record of when picks were submitted is definitive
- Firebase data — the actual stored picks are the official record
- Fairness to all players — decisions apply equally to everyone

In extreme circumstances where pool integrity cannot be maintained, the Pool Manager reserves the right to refund all entry fees and cancel the pool.

12.5 Rule Adjustments Mid-Season

Rules may only be adjusted mid-season in rare cases where fairness requires it. Any adjustment must be:

- Documented and announced to all players immediately
- Applied equally to all players
- Made in the interest of fairness — never to benefit any specific player

13. Results & Transparency

13.1 What Players Can See At All Times

- Pool #1 picks — all players can view everyone's Pool #1 picks immediately after submission
- Pool #2 picks — visible to all players only after the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week
- Pool #3 picks — visible to all players only after the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week
- Timestamps showing when each player last submitted their picks for each pool each week
- Prize standings and current leaders, updated automatically as games are finalized
- Perfect Score hits recorded as games are finalized — final payout amounts calculated only after the entire season is complete
- CSV download available from the all-players picks table for Pool #1, Pool #2, and Pool #3

13.2 Pool #2 and Pool #3 Blind Period

Pool #2 and Pool #3 picks are hidden from all other players until the Friday 11:59 PM PST deadline passes for that week. After the deadline, all picks become visible to everyone.

This blind period prevents players from copying each other's blind picks. Your Pool #1 picks are always visible immediately after submission.

13.3 Post-Weekend Communication

After each playoff weekend, the Pool Manager will send an email confirming:

- Prize winners for that week, with tiebreaker notes if applicable
- Perfect Score hits for that week

All actual scores, prize calculations, standings, and pick tables are displayed automatically in the app and are available to all players at any time.

14. Final Notes

This pool exists because of a shared love of football and friendly competition. The rules are designed to be fair, transparent, and final — so that everyone can focus on enjoying the playoffs rather than debating process.

The Golden Rule of This Pool

Enter your picks early. You can always edit them before the Friday deadline.

Waiting until the last minute is a choice — and the consequences are your own.

Questions or technical issues? Contact Pool Manager Richard using the contact information provided with your access code.

Good luck to all players — let the games begin! 🏈